

Radiolarian A single-celled oceanic organism that feeds like an animal and drifts as part of the zooplankton.

Reef A ridge of submerged rock, often created by marine animals called corals.

Reptile One of the group of animals that includes turtles, lizards, crocodiles, snakes, and dinosaurs.

Rift A crack in rocks or Earth's crust, caused by the rocks pulling apart.

Rift valley A region where part of Earth's crust has dropped into the gap formed by the crust pulling apart.

Rorqual A type of large filter-feeding whale with an expandable throat that can hold a lot of water containing food.

Satellite Something that orbits a planet, such as Earth, in space.

Scavenger An animal that eats the remains of dead animals and other scraps.

School A group of fish that live together and sometimes swims in perfect formation.

Seamount An ocean-floor volcano, active or extinct, that does not break the ocean surface to form an island.

Sediment Solid particles such as sand, silt, or mud that have settled on the seabed or ocean floor.

Shelf sea A shallow sea covering a continental shelf.

Shellfish A term for marine animals with either hard shells or external skeletons.

Silica A mineral made of oxygen and silicon, the main ingredient.

Single-celled Consisting of just one living cell. Plants and animals have many cells.

Siphon tube A tube used by a clam, squid, or other mollusk to draw water into its body or pump it out.

Solar system The system of planets, moons, and asteroids orbiting the Sun.

Southern hemisphere The region of Earth south of the equator.

Subduction The process of one plate of Earth's crust diving beneath another, creating an ocean trench, causing earthquakes, and fueling volcanoes.

Temperate A climate that is neither very hot nor very cold, or a region that has such a climate.

Tentacle A long, boneless extension of an animal's body, sometimes armed with stinging cells.

Thermocline The boundary between deep, cold, dense water and a layer of warmer, less dense water that floats at the surface of oceans.

Tidal To do with the tides.

Tidal race A fast-moving tidal current that has chaotic waves and whirlpools.

Tidal stream A horizontal flow of water created by the rise and fall of the tide.

Tidewater glacier A glacier that flows all the way to the coast and out to sea, so that its end floats on tidal seawater.

Tissue In biology, living material such as bone, muscle, or plant material.

Trade wind A wind that blows steadily from east to west over a tropical ocean.

Tsunami A destructive sea wave usually produced by an earthquake, but which can also be caused by volcanic eruptions and submarine landslides.

Tube feet Tubular, water-filled, mobile projections from the body of an echinoderm animal such as a starfish.

Tube worm A type of marine worm that lives in a protective tube.

Turbine A rotor driven by a flow of water or air, which can be used to turn an electricity generator.

Unicorn A mythical horse with a single horn in the middle of its forehead.

Upwelling zone A part of the ocean where deep water that is rich in plant nutrients is drawn up to the surface.

Venom Poison that a biting or stinging animal uses for hunting or defense.

Water vapor The gas that forms when liquid water is warmed and evaporates.

Westerly wind A wind that blows from west to east.

Zooplankton Animals that mainly drift in the water, although some swim actively.

